

How to automate a process using AutoIt

We first need to have AutoIt installed on our system. It just takes a few minutes to install it—simply click on *autoit setup.exe*. We need to additionally install *Scite Editor.exe* as well, in order to have the script editor in AutoIt.

Once we are done with the installation part, we need to simply right-click anywhere on the location where AutoIt has been installed, and follow the steps shown below to get the new *.au3* file created on our system.

Right click *New* -> *AutoIt v3 script* -> Give a name to the file -> Press *Enter*.

Once we have created the *.au3* file using the above steps, we need to just right click on this file and select the *Edit script* option to get an AutoIt script editor window, as shown in Figure 5.

This is where we can try our hand at scripting in order to make the AutoIt tool perform some task or action. Let's automate a simple scenario where the user is asked his/her name, and once that is entered in the input box, the user gets a 'Welcome' message. Before proceeding with the scripting part, we can add our name as the *Author* in the auto-generated template of the script editor window.

The requirements are:

1. The ability to display the question asking the user for his/her user name and to accept this input. To incorporate this, we need to have the predefined *InputBox* function of AutoIt.
2. The inbuilt *Message Box* function to display a *Welcome* message for the user. We will have to import the *MessageBoxConstants* library to use the *Message Box* function in our script.

Let's start scripting with the following steps:

1. Import all the required library files -- we need to include the *MessageBoxConstants* library file.
2. Declare all the types of variables required (integer, string, etc) using the keyword *Dim*.
3. As discussed in Requirement 1, use the *InputBox* function to ask and take the input from the user. We just need to type *Input* and then click *Ctrl + Space* to get various hints, and then we can select *InputBox* out of the options provided.
4. Insert an opening round brace just after *InputBox*; AutoIt will display the hint of the syntax to be followed for that specific function. So here, for *InputBox*, we need to enter the following parameters in sequence.
 - Title – title to appear on top of the Input Box window
 - Prompt – the question for which the user needs to provide input.
5. Once the user enters his/her name, we need to display the *Welcome* message using the name; so we will store the value of *InputBox* in a variable. We also need to verify whether the user has entered a name or not, so that we can display the *Welcome* or *Error* message accordingly. Hence, we will use the conditional *If-else* for that.

Finally, we are ready with the following AutoIt code:

```
; Including library files
#include <MsgBoxConstants.au3>

; Variable Declaration
Dim $UserName

; Taking input from User
$UserName=InputBox("User Name","Please enter the User Name")

; Validating if User has entered some User Name and then
displaying Welcome Message
If $UserName <> "" Then
MsgBox(0,"Welcome Message","Hey " & $UserName & ", Welcome to
AutoIt..!!!")
Else
MsgBox(0,"Error Message","Please enter the User Name")
EndIf
```

Once we run the above code using F5, we will get an input box for the user to enter his/her name (Figure 6).

Once the user enters some name, a *Welcome* message will be displayed (Figure 7).

If the user does not enter any name and clicks on OK, then an *Error* message is generated.

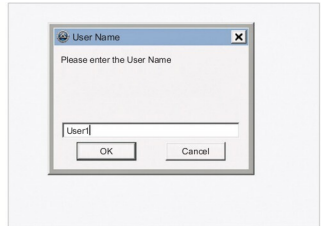


Figure 6: Input box window



Figure 7: Welcome message box